

Sony MDR-M1 Headphones

Great value for your money at ₹39,990

The professional headphones market in India has been brewing with offerings in the recent years with brands like Sony, Sennheiser, Beyerdynamic and Neumann locking horns to gain a spot in the studio setups of artists across the country. After their well-received Sony MDR-MV1 headphones, which were launched last year, Sony has thrown another hat in the ring, with the Sony MDR-M1 headphones.

Touted by the audio community as the spiritual successors to the ever-popular Sony MDR-7506, the MDR-M1 headphones bring quality build and performance to the table, without any unnecessary bells and whistles. With a fairly steep price tag of ₹39,990, these headphones might not be the go-to choice for everyone in a price-sensitive market like India. However, considering the competition they are jumping into, they have a great value proposition attached to them. To know more about what makes these headphones a great value for your money, read my review of the Sony MDR-M1 –

BUILD AND DESIGN

In terms of the build and design, the Sony MDR-M1 headphones borrow their base aesthetic from their predecessors, the Sony MDR-7506, improving on key areas like comfort and long-term usability. These headphones come with thick memory foam earcups and well-padded headband that ensures that you do not have any issues wearing them for longer periods of time. The headband has a metallic inlay, which ensures that these headphones will

₹39,990



is, you won't have to worry about it. I have prescription glasses and my head is slightly on the larger side, but I had no complaints or worry about the fit of these headphones.

These headphones have a primarily plastic construction, with the cans and the yoke being made of plastic, and as stated earlier, the headband, having a metallic inlay. If the longevity of Sony's

other professional headphones is anything to go by, then in long-term use, I am talking over a decade or longer. All you will need to replace will be the earpads, but the headphones will not give you anything to complain about.

The cable(s) also have nice rubberised outlet layer shielding, terminating in durable metallic connectors, ensuring that you won't have to worry about their longevity as well. These headphones scream quality, and you are getting what you pay for.

If you are a frequent traveller, I would recommend you get a case for these headphones and free up some space in your backpack, as they do not come with a case, and are not the most compact pair to carry around. But that is the case with most studio monitors, and this is something that is expected. So, I won't dock any points here. Rather, these headphones would earn a couple of extra points, because of their extremely lightweight design.

PERFORMANCE

In our headphone reviews, the features section usually follows the build and design section, but the Sony MDR-M1 headphones are studio monitors, and hence lack the bells and whistles of mainstream headphones. So, I will dive directly into their performance.

As is the case with Sony's studio headphones, the Sony MDR-M1 headphones come with a fairly neutral sound profile. The mids and the lows, come fairly close to our baseline reading of the pink noise, that we use as our reference. The highs get a slight boost, which adds a nice touch of brilliance to the sound of these headphones, and gives the vocals a much-needed presence for studio applications. To set things better in the context of real-world use, here's a quick glance at how these headphones performed in our various test parameters –

VERDICT

The bottom line with the Sony